



The Unsent Note: An Inference Notebook

Grade 4 • Connecticut • Reading

4.RL.1

Support explanations and inferences with details from an original story. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 4 • Connecticut • Reading; 4.RL.1. Focus: Support explanations and inferences with details from an original story.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

An inference joins a text clue to reasonable thinking. It is not a guess with no evidence. Separate what the story states from what you infer. Use a short quote or accurate paraphrase and explain why it supports your idea.

Model 1 • A child places wet boots by a dripping coat. Infer the weather.

It likely rained; both wet boots and dripping coat support the inference. The exact weather is not stated.

Model 2 • Can you infer the child's favorite color?

No. Nothing in those details supports a color preference.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



The Unsent Note

[1] June folded a note three times and slid it beneath her notebook. Across the classroom, Milo arranged the bridge model they had built together. One side leaned toward the table.

[2] “It was straight yesterday,” Milo said. June pressed her palms beneath her legs. At lunch she had moved the model to make space for her painting, and a sleeve had caught the support string. She had hoped the tilt was too small to notice.

[3] Their teacher announced that the models would be tested after recess. June took out the note. It began, “I need to tell you something.” She looked at Milo, who was searching the floor for a missing support clip.

[4] June stood. “The string caught on my sleeve when I moved it,” she said. “I should have told you.” Milo stopped searching. Then he set two clips beside the bridge. “Hold this side while I tighten it.”

[5] After the test, June unfolded the note. On the back she wrote, “Next time, sooner.” She left it inside her notebook where she would see it in the morning.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. What is explicitly wrong with the bridge in paragraph 1?

2. What caused the damage?

3. Infer why June hides the note at first. Cite a clue.

4. What does pressing her palms beneath her legs suggest?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. Why does the test announcement matter to June?

6. What might the note have been intended to do? Use evidence.

7. Is Milo shown blaming June before she speaks? Explain.

8. What does Milo's response suggest about his immediate priority?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Choose the better inference: June dislikes painting; June regrets waiting. Give evidence.

10. Is the bridge guaranteed to pass the test?

11. Give two details showing June takes responsibility.

12. Explain what “Next time, sooner” most likely means.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Why keep the note where she will see it?

14. Distinguish one stated fact and one inference.

15. Write a two-sentence evidence-based explanation of June's change.

16. Name one question the text leaves unanswered.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. Infer June's feeling before confession and cite a detail.

18. Infer Milo's response to working with June after the confession.

19. Explain why the final note matters.

20. Reject this claim with evidence: June never tells Milo what happened.



Answers and response criteria

1. One side leans toward the table.
2. June's sleeve caught the support string while she moved the model.
3. She is reluctant or anxious to admit fault; she hides it and hopes the tilt will not be noticed.
4. Nervousness or discomfort; connect the gesture to her concealed accident, not certain knowledge of her feelings.
5. It creates urgency: the damaged bridge will soon be tested, so keeping silent may harm their work.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. Tell Milo about the accident; its opening says she needs to tell him something.
7. No. He notices the tilt and searches for a clip; blame is not stated.
8. Repairing the bridge together; he asks June to hold it while he tightens it.
9. June regrets waiting; “I should have told you” and “Next time, sooner” support it.
10. No. The outcome is not stated; “after the test” only tells time.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. She identifies her sleeve as the cause and says she should have told Milo.
12. Admit an accident or problem earlier rather than hiding it.
13. Likely as a reminder to speak honestly sooner; supported by placement for the next morning.
14. Fact: she writes on the back. Inference: the note is a reminder. Require clear distinction.
15. From concealment to admitting responsibility; cite hiding/hope and confession/reminder.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Examples: whether the bridge passed or exactly how Milo felt. Do not supply an invented answer.
17. Anxiety/regret with hidden note or hand gesture; other supported feelings accepted.
18. He is willing to cooperate; asks her to hold the bridge.
19. It turns an unused confession note into a personal reminder about honesty/timing.
20. Paragraph 4 explicitly records her explanation about the sleeve and apology.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/sde/language-arts/ct-core-standards/ct-core-standards-for-ela-at-a-glance-grade-4.pdf?rev=98e99f6998a342c4a252c5f77fdafe94>

Research limit: official released-assessment retrieval was unsuccessful in this run. This packet is standards-focused classroom instruction; it makes no released-test alignment, timing, or scoring claim.

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